

Question 3 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the relationship between Human Resource Development and Human Resource Management.

Answer

HRM and HRD are related but not identical. HRM is the broader management of people; HRD is the developmental subset (and philosophy) within or alongside HRM.

- 1. HRM as umbrella:** HRM covers procurement, compensation, industrial relations, welfare, compliance and development. HRD specifically deals with training, career, potential, climate and learning.
- 2. Maintenance vs development:** HRM is largely maintenance-oriented (keeping the system running). HRD is development-oriented (growing people and the organisation).
- 3. Structure:** HRM structures tend to be independent functional units. HRD requires interdependent, inter-related structures because development cuts across departments.
- 4. Aims:** HRM emphasises efficiency, utilisation and control of human resources. HRD emphasises employee growth plus organisational effectiveness.
- 5. Responsibility:** HRM is typically the personnel/HR department's job. HRD responsibility rests with all managers at all levels, supported by HRD specialists.
- 6. Motivation:** HRM often uses monetary incentives. HRD stresses higher-order needs—recognition, achievement, learning and self-actualisation.
- 7. Complementarity:** Sound HRM policies (fair pay, security) create conditions in which HRD can work. HRD in turn improves the quality of HRM outcomes (performance, retention, succession).
- 8. Strategic linkage:** Modern strategic HRM treats HRD as a key lever: without HRD, HRM cannot build a future-ready workforce.

Conclusion. Hence HRD and HRM are interdependent: HRM provides the employment framework; HRD develops people within that framework toward organisational goals.